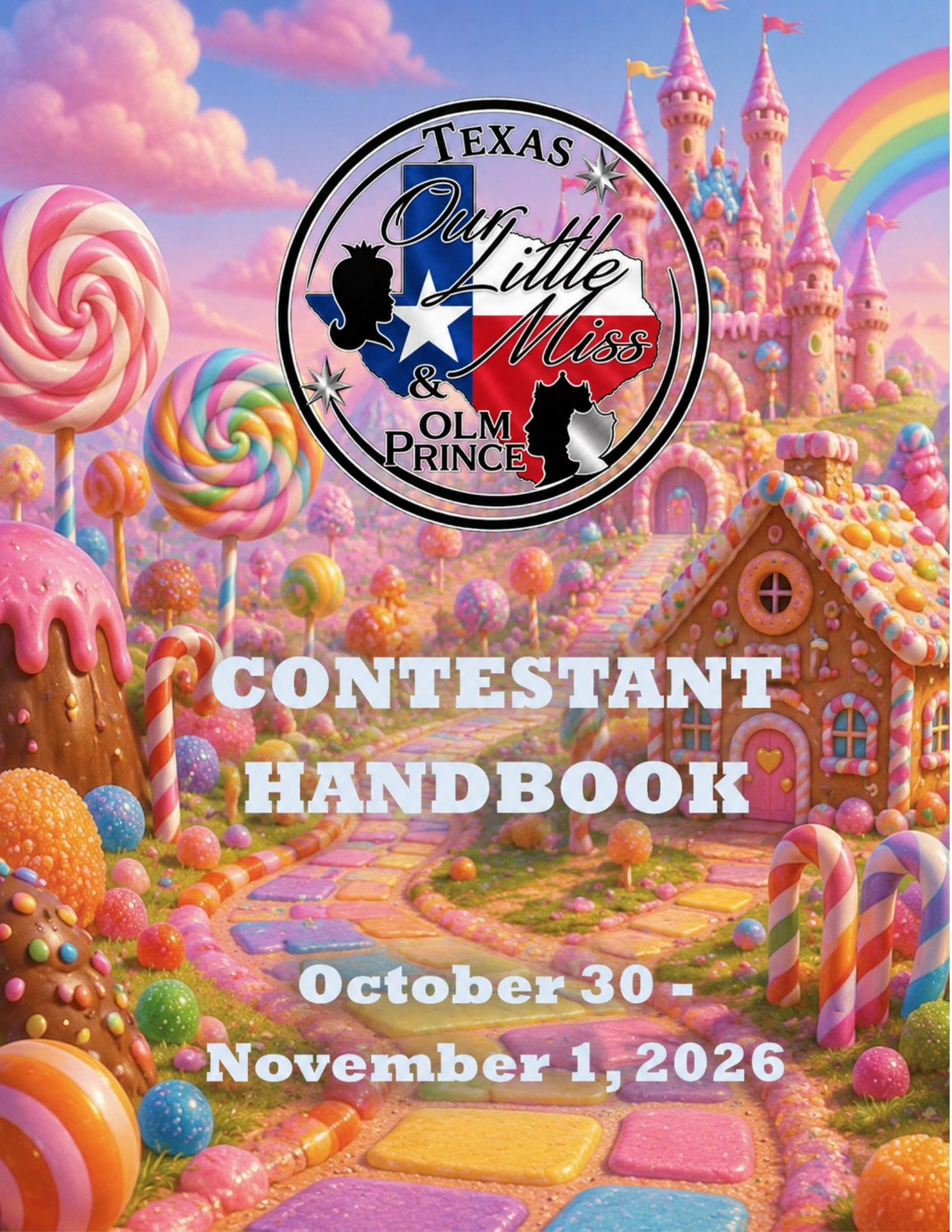


CONTESTANT HANDBOOK

October 30 - November 1, 2026

Welcome to Texas' Our Little Miss

Welcome to the Our Little Miss family! We are excited to have you join us for our 2026 Universal Beauty State Scholarship Competition! Our Little Miss has been around for more than 64 years and is still going strong!
Get ready to have a great time, have tons of fun, make memories that will last a lifetime!
This serves as your handbook for the state competition.

Age Divisions

0—2 years, 3—6 years, 7—9 years, 10—12 years, 13—15 years,
16—20 years, 21—39 years, and 40+ years
Some divisions may be split based on the number of entries.

Required Competitions

All age divisions must compete in Interview, Sportswear, and Party Dress/Evening Gown.
Clothing guidelines and examples can be found here in this handbook as well as on our website.

Optionals Offered

We offer the following optionals at our state competition:
Miss Photogenic, Livin' Doll, Commercial Print Categories, Pro-Am Modeling,
Optional Talent, Prettiest Eyes/Hair/Smile, Best Dress/Sportswear, Practice Interview,
Popular Miss!
Descriptions of all the optionals can be found on later pages in this handbook.

Award Information

The following awards will be awarded in each division:
Overall Divisional Queen, Princess (Successor), Personality Plus,
and Mini Queen, followed by Alternates, Semi Finalists, and Finalists

Overall Divisional Winner's Package:

Official Our Little Miss Rhinestone Crown, Monogrammed Satin-Backed Banner,
Official Scepter, Robe (use for 1 year), Banner Pins,
Rhinestone OLM pin, Community Appearances, Gifts,
Cash Scholarship*, and more!
**Scholarship given if reign is fulfilled and winner MUST compete in the World Competition!*
Scholarship amounts are determined by number of contestants in each division

Clothing Rules / Pageant Regulations



FIRST REMEMBER THAT WE ARE A NATURAL PAGEANT SYSTEM! ALL HAIR AND MAKE-UP MUST BE AGE APPROPRIATE!

We want the CHILD to shine, NOT the clothes!

EVENT	WHAT IS IT?	WHAT DO I WEAR?
Close—Up Appraisal *(Interview)* 	This is a time for the judges to see contestants up close and get to know them better! Chaperones for 0-2 contestants will introduce their contestant with their name, age (in months) and hometown. They will then tell the judges 2 or 3 fun/interesting facts about their contestant. Contestants ages 3 and up will introduce themselves to the judges by stating their name, age, city, and state followed by a basic turn. Contestants will then answer a set of age-appropriate questions.	***RECOMMENDED ATTIRE:*** **DRESS/ SKIRT AND TOP/JACKET** Think interviewing for a job! For younger contestants, we recommend a nice Sunday's Best Dress or for boys slacks and button down shirt. For older contestants, we recommend a office style dress or skirt with top/jacket. We highly suggest either no sparkle or very little sparkle on outfits! Keep it simple and classic! *See examples on the next page!*
Sportswear Personality 	Sportswear personality, all contestants will individually come to the microphone and introduce themselves by stating their name, age, city, followed by fun fact about them. Then will step to the spot in front of judges and do a turn, continue off stage. Once each contestant has modeled on stage, the whole age group will come back on stage for a parade of beauties.	***RECOMMENDED ATTIRE: SPORTSWEAR PERSONALITY*** Casual Wear should be a pant, short, or skirt outfit, or a dress that shows off their personal style. The outfit can be as simple or as formal as you would like! It should be modest, age—appropriate and should not be high glitz or costume looking. *See examples on the next page!*
Party Dress *(Beauty Wear)* 	Party Dress / Evening Gown, Formal Wear is our Beauty Wear competition. All contestants will individually model their beauty wear on stage. Once each contestant has modeled on stage, the whole age group will come back on stage for a parade of beauties.	***RECOMMENDED ATTIRE: BEAUTY DRESS*** Contestants ages 0—9 should wear a short pageant style dress while contestants ages 10 and up should wear a floor length gown. We love sparkle, but please no high glitz dresses! Ages 13+ are allowed to have one shoulder strap! Boys should wear a suit or formal wear. *See examples on the next page!*
Playtime 	Playtime is a time for them to show their personalities and ability to get along with others. 0-2 will go in and have floor time to get to know the other contestants in this group. 3 and up will go in with their age group and play age appropriate group games.	***RECOMMENDED ATTIRE: PLAYTIME*** Playtime attire will be your state t-shirt with khaki shorts or skort, white socks, white tennis shoes *See our website for examples!*

Additional clothing GUIDELINES

We are a natural pageant system! Clothes should be modest, conservative, and age appropriate!

These are the clothing rules that can not be broken:

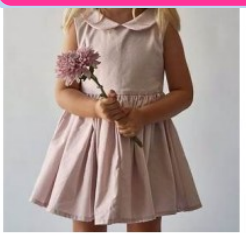
- No slits above the knee
- No strapless outfits—1" straps for ages 0—12 and at least spaghetti straps or one shoulder strap for ages 13+
- No tattoos visible on stage or in interview (This includes 0—2 chaperones)
- No exposed stomachs or midriffs
- No overdone jewelry or make—up for younger divisions especially

We are a natural pageant system! Clothes should be modest, conservative, and age appropriate!

Clothing Examples

More clothing examples can be found on our website www.louisianaolm.com

Close—up Appraisal (Interview)







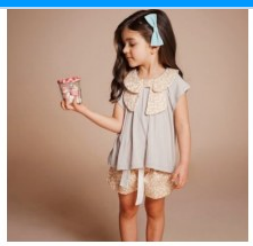


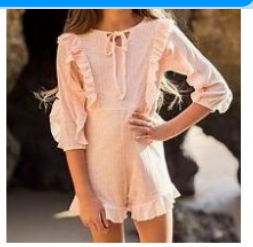




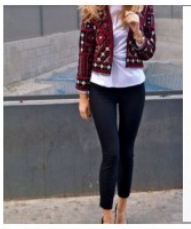
Sportswear (Casual Wear)







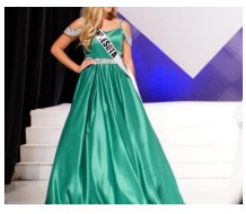


Party Dress/Evening Gown (Beauty Wear)



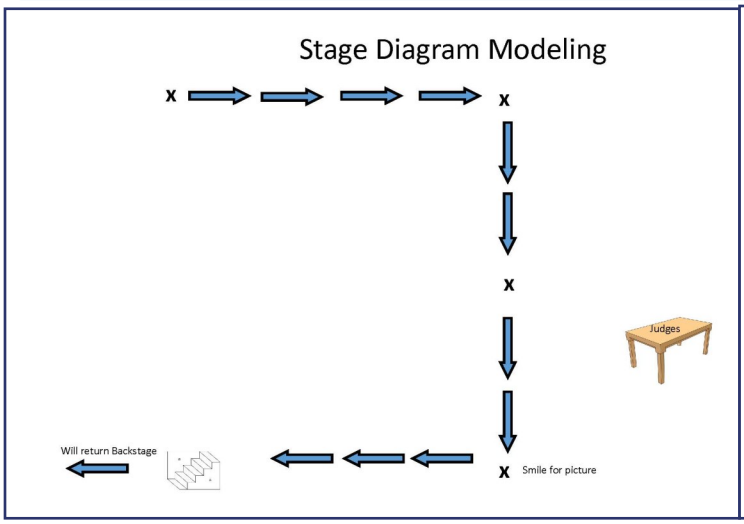


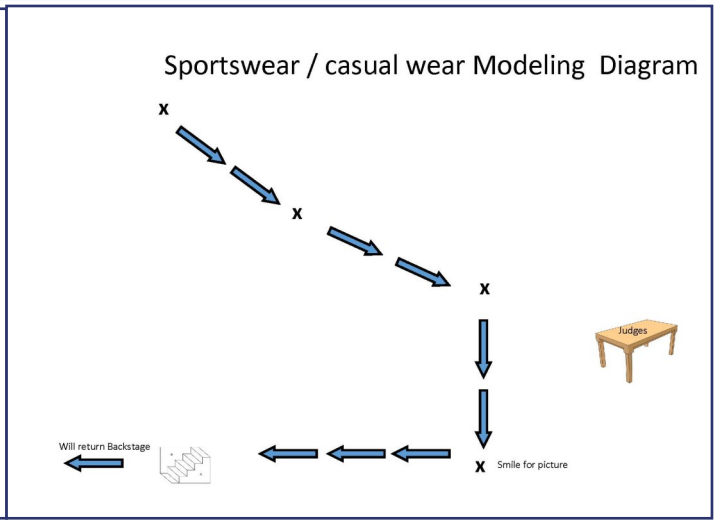






Modeling Formation





0—2 Contestants:

Chaperones will model their contestants (see rule below). We recommend turning your baby around at the front X so the judges can see the back of their outfit/hair/etc. Your baby can walk or be carried! It's your choice! Show off your baby, but remember….NO COACHING YOUR BABY ONSTAGE! Audience members can cheer for every contestant, but NO COACHING from the audience either!

3 and up Contestants:

Smile big! Don't forget eye contact with the judges! Don't go too fast or too slow! We prefer a nice, natural model! Contestants are free (not required) to do a step-step-turn or circle turn at the front X. We are a natural system and want natural modeling! AVOID sassy walks, hands-on hips, kissy faces, etc. NO COACHING from the audience either!

Group Line Up

For Sportswear and Party Dress, each age division will model individually. After everyone has modeled in that age group, the entire age group will go back on stage for a group line up. We will most likely ask the group to turn around once to see back of outfits/hair/etc.

On Stage Introductions/Questions

For the beauty wear competition, we will do a parade of beauties! Each contestant (or baby chaperone) will say their name, age, and hometown on stage to introduce themselves. They will then model beauty wear. If the judges request it, ages 3 and up will also answer an age-appropriate onstage question.

Hands-On Regulation for 0—2

ALL contestants in the 0-2 age division have a

HANDS ON RULE

for every competition. For safety purposes, the contestant's chaperone must keep his/her hands on the contestant at ALL times during official competition. So don't let go on stage! Don't let go in interview! This does not include the party or optional talent! Let them dance and have fun at the party. If they are competing in optional talent, the chaperone just needs to stand close to them.





Optional Competitions

Optional competitions are offered for extra practice and opportunities for optional category awards. Optional competition results do NOT change the outcome of the official results. All optional competitions are judged by a separate panel of judges. The official judges do not know who enters or wins the optional categories.

Miss Photogenic



Do you have a beautiful photo? To enter Miss Photogenic, your photo must be emailed to **texasolmpics@gmail.com** by **October 9, 2026**. No late entries will be accepted. Winner's will receive a full page in the program book along with a crown and banner. Glitz photos are not accepted. Judging is based on beauty, clarity, and personality of photo.

Livin' Doll *(Highly Recommended)*



Livin' Doll is a fun competition that is judged solely on facial beauty and stage presence by a different panel of judges. All you need is a beauty dress! It can be the same dress that you will wear for the main competition or a different one! **No rules for Livin' Doll dress**, so feel free to bring out the **SPARKLE**! This is a GREAT chance to practice your beauty modeling before the main competition. Winners will crowned right after the event!

Divisions: 0—18 months, 19—36 months, 3—4 years, 5—6 years, 7—9 years, 10—12 years, 13—17 years, 18+ years

Commercial Print Categories



We love to see your print work! Enter your Portfolio, Best Head Shot, Tear Sheets, and/or Zed Cards! Commercial print is judged based on all photogenic aspects: beauty, personality, clarity, and variety.
All entries must be turned in at Registration...**do not mail these items!!!**

→ **Portfolio:** Must be submitted in a picture book of some kind. Must contain 5 or more different shots. Pictures can be any size and picture color does not matter.

→ **Best Head Shot:** You can enter as many photos as you like for Best Head Shot. Must be individual pictures and should be a head and shoulder shot. Size and color of picture does not matter.

→ **Tear Sheet:** Have you ever been photographed for a magazine, newspaper, or any print item? If so, submit a copy of your work! Items must be fairly recent to your current age. Simply "tear" your work out and compete in Best Tear Sheet!



→ **Composite/Zed Cards:** Do you have an official modeling composite/zed card that you use at auditions? If not, feel free to make one and enter the Best Comp/Zed Card Competitions. Cards can be any size (5x7 is most popular) and on the front should be your best head shot and on the back should be a variety of your photos. Include your stats—Eye Color, Hair Color, Height, Weight, and any other information you use to book jobs! Color or BW pictures are accepted!



Optional Competitions Continued

Pro Am Modeling *(Highly Recommended)*



This competition is a fun way to get stage practice while modeling your favorite outfits/costumes. Judging will be based on stage presentation, facial beauty, grooming, and overall personality. Glitz and/or High Fashion model is not required. 1 score sheet per outfit will be given and a 1st, 2nd, and 3rd place will be awarded in each category per age division. This is also a great way to pick which sportswear and/or party dress/evening gown you want to use during official competition if you are having trouble deciding on one! Competition clothing rules, do not apply for Pro Am Modeling! Enter as many as you like, but enter **5 or more** and you will be eligible to win sweepstakes for your age division and possibly go on to compete in the ***Sweepstakes Challenge for the Model of the Year Title (crown, banner, & CASH prize)!***

If you enter more than 5 categories, we will take your 5 highest scores for the sweepstakes award.

Categories: Sportswear, Party Dress/Evening Gown, Rainwear, High Fashion, State/Country Costume, Sleepwear, Western Wear, Coat/Cape Wear, Today's Fad, School Uniform, Suede/Leather Wear, Animal Print, Character Costume, Vintage Wear, TV/Movie Costume, Hat Wear, Team Wear, Under the Sea , Occupation Attire, Glamo Camo

Optional Talent / Command Performance





Do you love to perform? Now is your chance! Open to ALL age groups!
1 score sheet per performance will be given and a 1st, 2nd, and 3rd place will be awarded in each category per age division. Please follow OLM guidelines for clothing. All acts must be appropriate for a family audience and talent time cannot exceed **2 minutes**! Enter as many as you like, but enter **5 or more** and you will be eligible to win sweepstakes for your age division and possibly go on to compete in the ***Sweepstakes Challenge for the Entertainer of the Year Title (crown, Banner, & CASH prize)***!

If you enter more than 5 categories, we will take your 5 highest scores for the sweepstakes award.

Categories: Vocal, Dance, Twirling, Instrumental, and Other
(Other includes Monologue, Art, Magic, Comedy, Juggling, Sign Language, Ventriloquism, etc.)

Prettiest Eyes, Hair, Smile, Dress & Sportswear—



One winner will be chosen per division per category. These will be judged throughout the entire pageant and the winners will be announced at Special Awards!
This is an easy way to compete for extra awards!

Practice Interview *(Highly Recommended)*



This optional is intended to help you practice your interview skills before the actual event. You will go through a mock interview session and will be given a score sheet with your critiques. This will allow you to feel more confident before entering the real event!

Popular Miss—



Sell ads for our program book and not only get discounts off your fees, but you will also gain points towards our Popular Miss Award. If you sell 5 or more full page ads or a combination of sizes to make full pages, you will be in the running for this award. You will win a free entry to next season's state competition, crown, and banner.



Sweepstakes Awards

Sweepstakes Divisions

0—2 years, 3—6 years, 7—12 years, 13+ years

An overall sweepstakes award is given based on the entry requirements and the highest score in each optional entered. Each sweepstakes award requires a certain amount of entries. Must have 10 or more contestants enter for cash payout

Pro/Am Modeling, Command Performance Sweepstakes

*One winner per Sweepstakes Division. Banner, Trophy, and **$50 CASH** award will be presented to each Sweepstakes Divisional Winner.*

*Must enter at least 5 Pro/Am Modeling Categories for Pro/Am Modeling Sweepstakes

*Must enter at least 5 Optional Talent Categories for Command Performance Sweepstakes

**Must have 10 or more contestants enter for cash payout

Sweepstakes Challenge

(Pro/Am Modeling and Command Performance Only)

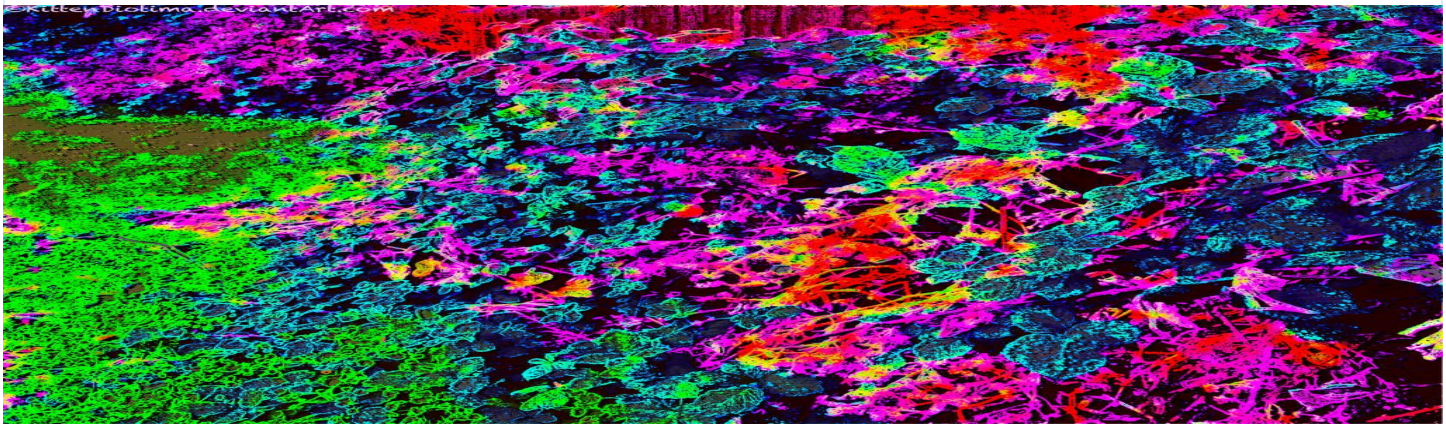
Each Sweepstakes Division Winner will compete against each other during the Sweepstakes Challenge for a chance to win the grand prize of an additional ***$100 CASH*** award!

Sweepstakes Challenge Details—All contestants that modeled 5 or more outfits or performed 5 or more talents will be recognized on stage! Then we will name the 4 Sweepstakes Division Winners for Pro/Am and the 4 Sweepstakes Division Winners for Command Performance Talent. Those winners will then re—compete against the other Sweepstakes Division Winners in their highest scoring Pro/Am or Command Performance Talent Event. Once every challenger has competed, we will then announce the Model of the Year and the Entertainer of the Year!

Must have at least 10 or more contestants for cash payout.

Texas's Model of the Year & Entertainer of the Year will each receive a

$100 CASH AWARD!!!



Program Book

Program Book Pictures: Picture Deadline—

October 9, 2026

Roster Photo:

Every contestant will get her picture printed in the State Program book. You must submit one picture with your forms by the deadline. The picture cannot be glitz and/or retouched. Natural photos only! Headshots work best!

Miss Photogenic:

All entering Miss Photogenic will get an additional picture printed in the book. This picture can be the same or different from your Roster Photo.

All Roster and Miss Photogenic pictures MUST be emailed to texasolmpics@gmail.com

Goody Bag/Royalty Gifts



Each contestant will be **required** to bring **50** small good luck gifts for the contestants and queens in their division. These should not be expensive, just thoughtful and creative.

Examples include: candy, pencils, note pads, bubbles, etc.

Each contestant will receive a goody bag during the state competition.

BRING YOUR GOODIES TO REGISTRATION TO FILL GOODY BAGS.

Every contestant is **required** to bring **2 royalty gifts to state**. These should be small gifts that will be given to the outgoing and incoming queens in their age division.

Each gift should cost no more than $5—$10 and should be appropriate for your age division.

Please write your name and age division on each gift.

BRING BOTH INCOMING & OUTGOING QUEEN GIFTS TO REGISTRATION.

Theme Party



Candyland with Trick or Treat!!

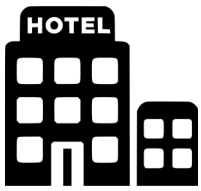
One Contestant Ticket and One Chaperone Ticket is included in your entry fee! Additional guests (ages 3 and older) will need to purchase a ticket if they would like to attend!

Additional party tickets are $45 and can be purchased in advance, at registration, or at the door subject to availability.

Hotels

All contestants and queens will be required to book at our host hotel. We will be staging in the hotel so you will be able to get ready in the comfort of your room and come down for each event to check in. Our host hotel is

Texas A&M Hotel and Convention Center
177 Joe Routt Boulevard
College Station, Texas 77843



Booking Website:
https://book.passkey.com/e/51323794

Guest Badges / Door Admission

Having family, friends, or other guests coming to watch?
Everyone **ages 3 and up** needs a Guest Badge!
Each contestant will receive ONE Chaperone Badge as part of their entry fee!
Other guests **ages 3 and up** will need to purchase a guest badge to watch the competitions.
Badges can be purchased for a single event or bundle and save by getting a weekend pass!
Prices are below! Please inform your guests that they will need a badge to enter!

Single Events = $10 each
*Does **NOT** include Grand Finals.*

Weekend Badge = $40
*Includes **ALL** staged events **INCLUDING** Grand Finals*

Grand Finals Only Badge = $25
*This badge is good for Grand Finals **ONLY**.*

Please note the above does NOT include the theme party.
Theme party tickets are sold separately.



Photos

You will be able to take pictures and video in the ballroom.

Enjoy your pictures!!!

State Deadline—October 9, 2026 Questions? Contact Angela Kyle or Julie Nice Email: texas@ourlittlemiss.com

Pageant Fees

This is a worksheet for you to use to help before you fill out the online forms!

Mandatory Fees—Choose one of the options below!

Entry Fee for all contestants is $560. Contestants that attended a preliminary pageant are eligible for a discounted entry fee (listed below) based on their placement at the preliminary pageant. Honor Roll contestants (have attended a state pageant in the past) are also eligible for a discount (listed below).

These fees include entry into all mandatory competitions for your age group, one chaperone badge, 1 program book, theme party ticket for contestant and chaperone !
The entry fees do not include any optionals you may choose to enter.

☐ **Won QUEEN at Preliminary Pageant = $370 Entry Fee**
For a contestant that just won QUEEN or PRINCESS at a preliminary pageant this season.

☐ **Won PRINCESS at Preliminary Pageant = $380 Entry Fee**
For a contestant that just won QUEEN or PRINCESS at a preliminary pageant this season.

☐ **Won PERSONALITY at Preliminary Pageant = $390 Entry Fee**
For a contestant that just won PERSONALITY, or ALTERNATE at a preliminary pageant this season.

☐ **Won ALTERNATE at Preliminary Pageant = $400 Entry Fee**
For a contestant that just won PERSONALITY, or ALTERNATE at a preliminary pageant this season.

☐ **Honor Roll Contestant = $330**
This option is for contestants that have entered an OLM state pageant in the past.

☐ **Contestant At—Large = $660 Entry Fee**
This option is for anyone that has never attended any Our Little Miss Competition.

☐ **Winner's Circle = $125/$175 Entry Fee**
This option is for a contestant that has already paid their deposit into the upcoming world pageant. They are just competing for practice and cannot win a divisional title

My Mandatory Fees = _____

Optional Fees

☐ **Miss Photogenic—1 photo = $50**	☐ **Miss Photogenic—2 photos = $80**
☐ **Livin' Doll Contestant = $50**	☐ **Commercial Head Shot = $20**
☐ **Commercial Print Portfolio = $20**	☐ **Commercial Tear Sheet = $20**
☐ **Commercial Zed Card = $20**	

☐ **Pro Am Modeling = $25 per entry** **5 proams for Model of the Year)**
Categories: Sportswear, Party Dress/Evening Gown, Rainwear, High Fashion, State/Country Costume, Sleepwear, Western Wear, Coat/Cape Wear, Today's Fad, School Uniform, Suede/Leather Wear, Animal Print, Character Costume, Vintage Wear, TV/Movie Costume, Hat Wear, Team Wear, Under the Sea , Occupation Attire. Model a great outfit for a great cause) (Enter 5 or more and qualify for a chance to win Division Sweepstakes and MODEL OF THE YEAR)

☐ **Optional Talent / Command Performance = $25 per entry (5 commands for Entertainer of the Year)**
Categories: Vocal, Dance, Twirling, Instrumental, and Other (Other includes Monologue, Art, Magic, Comedy, Juggling, Sign Language, Ventriloquism, etc.) (Enter 5 or more and qualify for a chance to win Division Sweepstakes and ENTERTAINER OF THE YEAR)

☐ **Prettiest Eyes = $20**	☐ **Prettiest Hair = $20**
☐ **Prettiest Smile = $20**	☐ **Best Dress = $20**
☐ **Best Sportswear = $20**	☐ **Practice Interview = $25**

☐ **Additional Party Tickets = $40** *(one contestant ticket and one chaperone ticket is included in your entry fee)*
Party tickets can be purchased in advance, at registration, or at the door subject to availability.

☐ **Guest Badges = See previous page for event pricing**
For additional guests (not chaperones) to enter all staged events (does not include the theme party)

My Optional Fees = _____

Looking for ways to raise money?

PATRON LISTINGS

Patron sponsors will be listed in the Official Program Book for only $10 per listing. The best part of all… $8 of every $10 you submit from your patron sponsors will be applied to YOUR pageant expenses! Each listing will consist of your contestant's name, patron's name, and a good luck message or well wish!

There is not a set limit on how many patron listings you are allowed to sell!

HOW DOES IT WORK? / WHAT DO YOU DO?

Ask friends/family/co-workers/anyone to send a good luck message or a well wish to your contestant for $10. You collect the $10 from them and send the $10 to State Headquarters. When the $10 is received, $8 will be subtracted off of your state balance! Type their message in the form below by October 9, 2026.

Send the money through
Venmo (@texasOLM), Cash App ($texasolm), or through your invoice.

SUBMIT PATRON MESSAGES HERE: texasolmpics@gmail.com

Must be entered by October 7, 2026

Example: Good Luck Sadie Berger! We love you to the moon and stars! - Grammy and Poppa

My Patron Listing Worksheet		
Patron Listing	***Price***	***You Receive***
Patron Listing	$10	$8 credit

ADVERTISING

Sell ads to earn credits! Prices and credits are described below! If you want the contestant's photo added to the ad, it will cost an additional $10! Qualify for Popular Miss by selling a combination of 5 pages!

There is no limit to the number of ads you can sell!

HOW DOES IT WORK? / WHAT DO YOU DO?

Ask friends/family/businesses/anyone to purchase an ad for our program book. It is similar to ads you see in a program at a football game or dance recital. You collect the money from them and send the money to State Headquarters. Your state balance will be credited after the money is received!
We can use business cards, flyers, or State Headquarters is happy to design something for you!
All information about the ad (name, ad size, graphics/photos, text, etc) must be emailed by the date below!
Venmo (@texasOLM), Cash App ($texasolm), or through your invoice.

Submit ad details here: texasolmpics@gmail.com

Email ad information to texasolmpics@gmail.com by October 7, 2026

My Ad Worksheet			
Page Size	***Size***	***Price***	***You Receive***
Full Page	8 x 10	$200	$100 credit
Half Page	8 x 5	$150	$75 credit

